

THE PLAYBOOK

Faceless Shorts

Post short videos every day without showing your face, using only free apps. Includes 60 hook templates, 5 formats, a 30-day calendar and a monetization map.

No income promises. This playbook gets you posting consistently, which is the part most people never get past.

How to use this playbook

1. **Today:** pick your niche (Section 1). It takes 15 minutes.
2. **Tomorrow:** set up the free workflow (Section 4) and make your first video.
3. **For 30 days:** follow the calendar (Section 5). One video a day, about 30 minutes each.
4. **Every 7 days:** do the 5-minute review (Section 6).

The only rule: post every day for 30 days before you judge anything. Most accounts look dead for the first 2–3 weeks. Short-form platforms test each video with a small audience first, and you need volume before one breaks through.

What you need

- A phone
- CapCut (free) for editing and auto-captions
- Canva (free) for text screens and thumbnails
- Free stock B-roll: Pexels, Pixabay, or CapCut's built-in library
- Optional: the free voices in CapCut's text-to-speech, if you don't want to record your own

1. Pick a niche you can post in for 90 days

Choose a niche you can make 90 videos about without running out of ideas. It should be something people search for, with a way to earn money from it later.

Question	Your answer
3 topics I could talk about for an hour with no prep	
What do people ask me for help with?	
Which of these do people <i>buy things</i> for? (products, apps, courses, services)	
Write 10 video ideas for your top pick in 5 minutes. Can you?	

Decision rule: if you can't list 10 ideas in 5 minutes, pick another niche. If two niches pass, pick the one where people already spend money.

Strong faceless niches

Personal finance tips, cooking and recipes, tech and app tips, fitness at home, productivity, history and "did you know" facts, local guides, product demos (hands only), and motivation with stock B-roll.

2. The 5 faceless formats

Format 1: List or countdown

"3 things..." or "5 apps...". One item per 2–3 seconds, big text on screen, B-roll behind it. **Best for:** any niche. The easiest to make.

Format 2: Screen-record tutorial

Record your phone or computer screen doing the thing. Zoom in on taps and add captions. **Best for:** tech, apps, finance tools.

Format 3: Text story over B-roll

A short story told in on-screen text (3–6 lines) over a satisfying or relevant clip. **Best for:** motivation, life lessons, "storytime".

Format 4: Voiceover explainer

You (or a text-to-speech voice) explain one idea in 20–40 seconds over B-roll and captions. **Best for:** facts, history, finance, education.

Format 5: Hands-only demo

Film your hands doing something: cooking, unboxing, a before/after, a DIY. No face needed. **Best for:** cooking, products, crafts, beauty.

Structure for every format:

0–2 s: the hook (text on screen *and* spoken).

2–20 s: the value, delivered fast. Cut every pause.

Last 2 s: a loop back to the start, or a call to action ("follow for part 2", "save this").

3. 60 hook templates

Swap X for your topic. Put the hook on screen in the first second.

Money & side hustles

1. Stop doing X if you want to save money.
2. 3 money habits nobody taught you in school.
3. I tried X for 30 days. Here's what I actually made.
4. The \$5 rule that changed how I spend.
5. If you're broke in your 20s, watch this.
6. This is how much X really costs (no one talks about it).
7. You're losing money every month on X.
8. 3 apps that pay you back on stuff you already buy.
9. Rich people don't do X. Here's why.
10. Save this before your next paycheck.

Fitness

1. You don't need a gym to do X.
2. Stop doing X at the gym. Do this instead.
3. 3 exercises that fix your posture in 5 minutes.
4. I did X every day for 30 days.
5. The mistake 90% of beginners make on X.
6. Here's what 10,000 steps a day actually does.
7. Do this before bed if you're always sore.
8. The easiest way to start working out (for lazy people).
9. Your form on X is wrong. Here's the fix.
10. 3 high-protein snacks under 200 calories.

Cooking

1. You've been cooking X wrong your whole life.
2. 3-ingredient X that tastes like a restaurant.
3. Dinner for 4 under \$10. Here's how.
4. Stop throwing away X. Do this instead.
5. The 5-minute X I make every week.
6. Meal prep for the week in 30 minutes.
7. This one trick makes X 10× better.
8. What I eat in a day for under \$15.
9. Don't buy X pre-made. Make it in 2 minutes.
10. The secret ingredient chefs don't tell you about.

Tech & apps

1. 5 free apps that feel illegal to know.
2. Stop paying for X. Use this free tool.
3. Your phone has a hidden setting that does X.
4. 3 AI tools that save me 10 hours a week.
5. Turn this setting off right now.
6. This website does X for free.
7. iPhone users, you need to try this.
8. The fastest way to do X on your computer.
9. I replaced 5 apps with this one.
10. Nobody uses this feature, but they should.

Motivation & self-improvement

1. This is your sign to start X.
2. 3 habits that made my 20s easier.
3. Do this for 5 minutes every morning.
4. Stop waiting to feel ready.
5. The 2-minute rule that ended my procrastination.
6. Read this if you feel behind in life.
7. What I wish I knew at 18.
8. One habit that changed everything for me.
9. You're not lazy. Here's what's actually happening.
10. Discipline is just this one thing.

Local business

1. Hidden gem in [city] most people don't know about.
2. 3 things to do in [city] this weekend.
3. The best \$10 meal in [city].
4. Before you hire a X, ask these 3 questions.
5. What a X really costs in [city].
6. A local's guide to [neighborhood].
7. Watch this before your next car detail.
8. How to tell if your X needs replacing.
9. We tested 5 X in [city]. Here's the winner.
10. Tourist trap vs local favorite in [city].

4. The free 30-minute workflow

Step	What to do	Time
1. Script	Write the hook plus 3–5 short lines. Read it out loud and cut any word you don't need.	5 min
2. Footage	Film your hands or screen, or grab 3–5 free clips from Pexels or CapCut's library.	8 min
3. Voice (optional)	Record a voiceover in CapCut, or use its text-to-speech.	3 min
4. Edit in CapCut	New project, 9:16. Drop in the clips and trim each to 1.5–3 s. Text → Auto captions. Put the hook text in big type at the top third.	10 min
5. Export	1080p, 30 fps. Upload natively to each platform, with no watermarks from other apps.	2 min
6. Post	Caption = hook + 3–5 relevant hashtags. Post at the same time every day.	2 min

Safe zones

Keep important text out of the bottom ~20% and the right edge. That's where captions, buttons and usernames cover the video on TikTok, Reels and Shorts.

Batch it

Make 5–7 videos in one sitting on the weekend and schedule them. One session a week is how this stays manageable.

5. Your 30-day calendar

Day	Format	Hook to try	Views after 48 h
1	List/countdown	Hook #8	
2	Hands-only demo	Hook #15	
3	Text-story over B-roll	Hook #22	
4	Voiceover explainer	Hook #29	
5	Screen-record tutorial	Hook #36	
6	List/countdown	Hook #43	
7	Weekly review (Section 6). Re-post your best video with a new hook.		
8	Text-story over B-roll	Hook #57	
9	Voiceover explainer	Hook #4	
10	Screen-record tutorial	Hook #11	
11	List/countdown	Hook #18	
12	Hands-only demo	Hook #25	
13	Text-story over B-roll	Hook #32	
14	Weekly review (Section 6). Re-post your best video with a new hook.		
15	Screen-record tutorial	Hook #46	
16	List/countdown	Hook #53	
17	Hands-only demo	Hook #60	
18	Text-story over B-roll	Hook #7	
19	Voiceover explainer	Hook #14	
20	Screen-record tutorial	Hook #21	
21	Weekly review (Section 6). Re-post your best video with a new hook.		
22	Hands-only demo	Hook #35	
23	Text-story over B-roll	Hook #42	
24	Voiceover explainer	Hook #49	
25	Screen-record tutorial	Hook #56	
26	List/countdown	Hook #3	
27	Hands-only demo	Hook #10	
28	Weekly review (Section 6). Re-post your best video with a new hook.		
29	Voiceover explainer	Hook #24	
30	Screen-record tutorial	Hook #31	

6. The 5-minute weekly review

1. List this week's videos and their views after 48 hours.
2. Circle the top 2. What do they share: the hook, format, topic or length?
3. Next week, make **3 more versions** of the winner. Change only the hook or the first 2 seconds.
4. Drop any format that came in last 2 weeks in a row.
5. Check your average watch time. If people leave in the first 3 seconds, the hook is the problem. If they leave in the middle, the video is too long.

Week	Best video	Why it worked	Next week I'll...
1			
2			
3			
4			

7. The monetization map

Payout rules and requirements change often, so check the official pages below for current numbers instead of trusting anyone's screenshot (ours included).

Path	How it pays	Where to check the current rules
YouTube Partner Program	Share of ad revenue on Shorts and long videos	support.google.com/youtube → "YouTube Partner Program overview"
TikTok creator programs	Payouts for eligible longer videos, plus TikTok Shop affiliate commissions	TikTok app → Creator tools, and the TikTok Creator Academy
Instagram / Facebook	Bonuses, subscriptions and gifts (they vary by region)	Professional dashboard in the app
Affiliate links	Commission when someone buys through your link	Amazon Associates, Impact, ShareASale, or brand programs
Your own product	You keep the margin (digital products ≈ 90%+)	Shopify Digital Products, Gumroad, Stan Store

Disclose paid links. When you earn from a link, say so (#ad, "affiliate link"). It's required in the US, and it keeps your account safe.

The order that usually works

1. Post daily until one format clearly wins.
2. Add an affiliate link or a low-price product that matches that format.
3. Turn on platform payouts when you qualify.
4. Build an email list (a free checklist works) so you own your audience.